

Q1. Why do you think our national movement supported the idea that all adults have a right to vote? Ans: the nationalist movement became successful because people from various backgrounds joined it. With the coming of independence it was felt that all persons in independent India should participate in making decisions. The govt. must be sensitive to people's needs and demands. It is, therefore, the constitution of independent India laid down the principle of Universal Adult Franchise i.e., that all adult citizens of the country have a right to vote. By exercising this right, people (adults) would participate in functioning of the government through their representatives. This is the essence of a democratic govt.

Q2. Do it yourself.

Q3. Do it yourself.

ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS

Q1. Describe briefly about the Lok Sabha.

Ans: The Lok Sabha is the lower house of the parliament. It is the house of the people because its members are directly elected by the people. The elections of Lok Sabha are held on the basis of Universal Adult Franchise. At present, the total membership of the Lok Sabha is 545, in which 543 are elected members while 2 are nominated. The speaker conducts the proceeding of Lok Sabha and maintains order within the house. In his/her absence, a Deputy speaker carries out the proceedings of the house. The term of the Lok Sabha is of five years. The term can be extended by the parliament in case of emergency. It can be dissolved before the expiry of its term by the president, if the ruling party loses its majority.

Q2. Describe briefly about the Rajya Sabha.

Ans: The Rajya Sabha is the upper house of the parliament. The total strength of the Rajya Sabha is 245, in which 233 members are elected

while 12 members are nominated by the president. The Rajya Sabha is chaired by the vice president of India. Rajya Sabha initiates the legislation and a bill is required to pass through the Rajya Sabha in order to become a law. The Rajya Sabha is a permanent house of the parliament. One-third of its members retire after every two years, and another one-third are elected who replace those who retire. The term of every member is six years. The Rajya Sabha is never fully dissolved.

Q3. Why are some seats reserved in the parliament for SC's and ST's?

Ans: Some seats are reserved in the parliament for SCs and STs because:

1. When interests and experiences separate us, it is important to ensure that communities that have been marginalized are given adequate representation.
2. The MPs elected from SCs and STs will be familiar with and can represent Dalit and Adivasi interests in parliament.

Q4. What is meant by opposition parties?

Ans: After election results are declared, the leader of the party with clear majority of elected members is invited by the president to form a govt. The other political parties form the opposition. The largest amongst these parties is known as the opposition party.

Q5. what is meant by coalition government?

Ans: Coalition government is one in which two or more political parties cooperate to create an alliance that forms the government. This situation occurs when no party gets a clear majority of votes in the election.